

The Wethersfield Historic District Commission held a virtual meeting broadcast from the Council Chambers of Town Hall, 505 Silas Deane Highway, Wethersfield, Connecticut on November 23, 2021.

Members Present: Jennifer Wolf, Chairperson
Mark Raymond, Vice Chairperson
Chris Lyons, Clerk
Clare Meade
Kathleen Williams
Chris Hall, Alternate
Vacek Miglus, Alternate
Damien Cregeau, Alternate

Not Present: None

Also Present: Kim Wolf, Historic District Coordinator
Linda Messina, Recording Secretary

Commissioner Wolf called the meeting to order at 7:30 PM, and read the opening comments. Commissioner Lyons read the Legal Notice as it appeared in the *Rare Reminder* on November 18, 2021.

APPLICATION NO. 7000-21. Charles Drake Enterprises LLC seeks to install a patio, fencing, stone retaining walls, pergola, lighting, and landscaping on left side of building at 161 Main Street. (Last date to act is November 23, 2021.)

Bryce Hardy, The Charles, 161 Main Street, and Joe Urso, SLR Consulting, appeared before the Commission. They have a fence as a perimeter. Samples were provided. Drawings were submitted and screens were shared. They will have a gravel seating area. There will be a 4' stone wall to create a separation from the parking lot. They also provided a sample of the stone knee wall. They will add string lighting and lighting in the bollards. The plans for the pergola are currently on hold. Commissioner Wolf asked if they could stake out the project. **UPDATE** - Bryce Hardy, 297 Hartford Avenue, appeared before the Commission. More detail on the service station area was provided. Screen sharing was enabled. The detail for the cut sheet on the posts that will hold the string lights was provided. Commissioner Wolf asked about how much grass to patio there will be. He's not sure of the exact dimensions, but there is about 35' of patio that comes out from the building. There is maybe 15' to 20' of grass that will be surrounding that. Commissioner Wolf asked how tall is the black aluminum portion of the fence. By code, it has to be 48" for liquor law. Commissioner Meade asked about the pergola. He is not proposing the pergola at this time because he doesn't have the specifics on it yet. Commissioner Meade asked about the fireplace. There is a fireplace between Center Street and the parking lot. Commissioner Meade stated that the fence should have been wrought iron or white picket. The aluminum is very utilitarian and looks like something you would have around a pool. There is a lot of stacked stone. It's not that it's not nice looking. It just looks like it should be next to a brand new restaurant. What would be more historically appropriate would be brick. They picked that fence because the HDC approved it on Garden Street. They are very different applications. Commissioner Wolf stated that she feels that the pergola is an integral part of how all of this works. Commissioner Williams asked about the seating in the grassy area. There would be no tables. The plan is to use the area for people to have a drink out there but the idea is not to serve food out there. Inside the walls of the patio are 50 seats. Outside the patio, they will just have a few clusters of Adirondack chairs. Commissioner Williams stated that the stone that they have chosen looks very modern. The restaurant reads very modern to her. She is concerned about the lighting. Commissioner Wolf stated that the chairs on the lawn would be a temporary structure and they don't

monitor that. He is open to alternate plans for the stone. Commissioner Wolf stated that they do appreciate the detail that has gone into the plan and his willingness to discuss options with them. Commissioner Miglus stated that the stone that is proposed is not a native stone. They will try to minimize the lighting. The pergola options he looked into are incredibly expensive. Commissioner Cregeau stated that this is a beautiful design for a restaurant but this is in a historic district. What can they do to make it look somewhat conforming to that Victorian historic look? He doesn't think brick makes an improvement over the stone because they are both commercial materials. Ironically if they were stone walls made by a stone mason, suddenly it looks more natural. **UPDATE** - Bryce Hardy, The Charles, 161 Main Street, and Joe Urso, SLR Consulting, appeared before the Commission. Screen sharing was enabled to show updates/changes. There is no fence needed in the front yard any longer. They just need a defined border. They have a landscaped bed with planters, boulders, and a tree. They left access for lawn equipment. There will be a 3' tall gate. On the main entrance on Main Street, they removed the fencing in between the bollards. They kept the fencing along the entire walkway. They kept a 4' tall fence to blend with the stone piers. They kept the stone wall in the back for privacy. The fence does have a 2' topper. All dimensions were added to the drawings. Details for the pergola and the string lights were provided. The pergola is 21x24 and 9' tall. The stone wall will match the knee wall and the piers. The knee wall is 2.3' at its highest. It has difference in elevation. They are proposing one fire pit. Commissioner Wolf asked about the plantings. They have fountain grass, inkberry, and black-eyed Susans, and California privet. Commissioner Meade explained the different plantings. Commissioner Meade asked how necessary the knee wall is functionally and asked if they could replace it with a clipped green evergreen hedge. It is very necessary. There is a drop in elevation.

Commissioner Wolf asked whether there was anyone wishing to speak in favor or in opposition to this application.

Michael Peretto, 120 Hartford Avenue, spoke in favor of the application.

Commissioner Wolf asked whether there was anyone wishing to speak in favor or in opposition to this application. There being no one, this portion of the hearing was declared closed.

APPLICATION NO. 7006-21. Renewal by Andersen seeks to replace seven (7) windows in home with Renewal by Andersen double-hung windows with white exteriors and no grilles at 396 Main Street.

Eileen Beaulieu, 396 Main Street, and Roger Coutin, Renewal by Andersen, 10 Reservoir Road, Smithfield, RI, appeared before the Commission. They would like to change seven windows. They are doing like for like changes to what is there now. They will be insert windows. They aren't changing the interior and exterior trim. Photos were provided. The windows will be white and they will have no grilles. They don't have a plan to do all of the windows at this time.

Commissioner Wolf asked whether there was anyone wishing to speak in favor or in opposition to this application. There being no one, this portion of the hearing was declared closed.

APPLICATION NO. 7007-21. PK Windows LLC seeks to replace 21 windows in home with Andersen Woodwright double-hung windows at 75 Center Street.

Paul O'Doherty, PK Windows LLC, 30 4 Mile Road, West Hartford, and Peter Sywenkyj, 75 Center Street, appeared before the Commission. They will not replace any of the curved windows. They would like to replace 21 windows with Andersen Woodwright double-hung windows. The aluminum storm windows will be removed.

Commissioner Wolf asked whether there was anyone wishing to speak in favor or in opposition to this application. There being no one, this portion of the hearing was declared closed.

APPLICATION NO. 7008-21. Michael and Marisa Peretto seek to install 5' high stockade wood fence on right side yard and also a split-rail fence around rear yard at 120 Hartford Avenue.

Michael Peretto, 120 Hartford Avenue, appeared before the Commission. The fence will come from Cape Cod Fence Company. It will be a privacy fence that is 45' long and 5' high. The rest of the fence will be a split-rail fence around the property. Detail and plot plan were provided. Commissioner Wolf stated that she has a little concern over the front placement. It is so forward that it will block the side door from view. The further back it goes, it blocks more of the porch. It would look awkward behind the porch. Commissioner Raymond stated that the fence is a little too forward for him as well.

Commissioner Wolf asked whether there was anyone wishing to speak in favor or in opposition to this application. There being no one, this portion of the hearing was declared closed.

APPLICATION NO. 7009-21. Anthony Costello seeks an approval for the GAF Fortitude shingle line, not currently on the list of pre-approved shingles in the District, to be installed at 16 Church Street.

Application was withdrawn by homeowner.

APPLICATION NO. 7010-21. Gove Restoration LLC seeks to replace windows in home with Marvin Elevate in Bronze color with same light patterns at 161 Garden Street.

Matt Gove, Gove Restoration, LLC, 70 Main Street, appeared before the Commission. They would like to replace 33 windows on the house (with the exception of the porch). They now have aluminum storm windows that would be removed. The house has detailed molding. They would like to use Marvin Elevate windows in the Bronze color. They will have a full screen. The SDL bars will be 7/8". On the porch, they will paint the windows to match the Bronze windows. The sill is the brick bottom. They have a sizeable storm window expander. They will have a small, lower profile sill. He believes they are the original windows.

Commissioner Wolf asked whether there was anyone wishing to speak in favor or in opposition to this application. There being no one, this portion of the hearing was declared closed.

Upon motion by Commissioner Raymond, seconded by Commissioner Meade, and a poll of the Commission, it was voted to close the public hearing on all applications and to open the public meeting.

Aye: Wolf, Raymond, Lyons, Meade, Williams

APPLICATION NO. 7000-21. Charles Drake Enterprises LLC seeks to install a patio, fencing, stone retaining walls, pergola, lighting, and landscaping on left side of building at 161 Main Street. (Last date to act is November 23, 2021.)

Upon motion by Commissioner Raymond seconded by Commissioner Lyons and a poll of the Commission, it was voted to APPROVE the application as submitted.

Discussion

Commissioner Raymond stated that he loves the plantings to soften up the setting. He is happy to see the pergola being a solid wood product. It's a pretty well buttoned up plan and it will be welcomed in the District.

Commissioner Wolf stated that she's happy to see the pergola back in. She thinks it's appropriate for this era building and it helps tie the project to the building. She's happy that they don't have to deal with the perimeter fence anymore either.

Commissioner Meade stated that the stacked stone is a modern material and something they have seen in lots of applications. It's going to look modern and jarring to an extent. It's not that it's aesthetically displeasing. It's that it's not necessarily appropriate or the best material next to an iconic house in Wethersfield. She also thinks that they need to be very careful in thinking they've got lots of great ideas coming along Main Street and they might see more and more of that material. She wonders if it might be possible to soften some of these walls with some greenery. For instance, on the parking lot side, they've got some grasses. Those grasses are going to be gone for a large part of the year. They could stipulate that along the parking lot side there could be evergreens that would soften the look coming up Center Street where you are really going to see a lot of that stacked stone wall. Also, at the back of the area as you stand on Main Street and you look towards the pergola and the patio, there's the wall, but on the left-hand side where the firepit area is, again there are grasses there that are not going to be evergreen. She wonders if stipulating some tall evergreen material there would also soften that large wall. She thinks it would be lovely not to have the knee wall.

Commissioner Lyons stated that the only thing he doesn't really like about it is the topper on the 4' wall by the parking lot. He thinks the plantings are great. It's been well presented and he appreciates the effort they put into it.

Commissioner Williams stated that she really appreciates the fact that the fence is going. She took a peek at the fence material and the aluminum was shiny and she wasn't a fan of the bright shiny fence even though it was black. She's also thinking of more evergreen plantings. She's not a fan of the grasses. She thinks they are lovely but they are modern. She likes that the lighting has been changed a bit.

Commissioner Cregeau stated that he completely echoes the sentiments of Commissioner Meade and Commissioner Williams.

Commissioner Hall stated that they should just keep in mind that with landscaping, it needs to be maintained.

Commissioner Miglus stated that the drawings submitted are wonderful and they show perfectly sized plants and from what he's seen, grasses can be maintained at a reasonable size. From what he's seen with evergreens to keep them small and manageable and confined to a small area is that you have to be relatively aggressive with the trimming and some of the objections that were raised with

the grasses and materials of this contemporary look would just be duplicated by trying to maintain shrubbery to a very tight confine. He thinks you are basically robbing Peter to pay Paul and you are going to end up with a similar set of issues.

Aye: Wolf, Raymond, Lyons

Nay: Williams, Meade

APPLICATION NO. 7006-21. Renewal by Andersen seeks to replace seven (7) windows in home with Renewal by Andersen double-hung windows with white exteriors and no grilles at 396 Main Street.

Upon motion by Commissioner Wolf seconded by Commissioner Raymond and a poll of the Commission, it was voted to APPROVE the application as submitted.

Discussion

Commissioner Wolf stated that she thinks in this particular location although they prefer to see all of the windows approved at the same time with the same product, they've already had some windows replaced and because they are very large windows with no light divisions, she thinks that this product for this project is appropriate.

Aye: Wolf, Raymond, Lyons, Meade, Williams

APPLICATION NO. 7007-21. PK Windows LLC seeks to replace 21 windows in home with Andersen Woodwright double-hung windows at 75 Center Street.

Upon motion by Commissioner Lyons seconded by Commissioner Raymond and a poll of the Commission, it was voted to APPROVE the application with the following stipulations:

1. The front five windows on the first floor between the sun porch and the front entry shall be Fibrex new construction windows.

Discussion

Commissioner Meade stated that they have approved this product in this area. In her opinion that was not a successful installation.

Commissioner Wolf stated that she thinks that it's a good compromise to have those windows be new construction because those are the ones that are concerning. Because of the narrowness of the window, too much light will be lost.

Commissioner Miglus stated that they should keep in mind that with the drawings that were submitted, they are going to be losing 3 3/8" for every window that you put in unless it's new construction. While the second floor front facing windows might not be that much of a concern, the dormer windows on the second floor aren't particularly big.

Aye: Wolf, Raymond, Lyons

Nay: Meade, Williams

APPLICATION NO. 7008-21. Michael and Marisa Peretto seek to install 5' high stockade wood fence on right side yard and also a split-rail fence around rear yard at 120 Hartford Avenue.

Upon motion by Commissioner Wolf seconded by Commissioner Lyons and a poll of the Commission, it was voted to APPROVE the application with the following stipulation:

1. The stockade style fence to the right of the house shall be placed parallel to the back edge of the main body of the house, the line running from the second floor or at the very back edge of the house at the homeowner's choice.

Discussion

Commissioner Wolf stated that she thinks it's a great fence. It's appropriate put back further from the street so as not to interfere with the view from the street of the main body of the house and that side porch and giving them the option to run it from the natural line from the second floor on the main body of the house or the back edge of the house gives them options to place it where they want and satisfy what looks appropriate for the District.

Aye: Wolf, Raymond, Lyons, Meade, Williams

APPLICATION NO. 7010-21. Gove Restoration LLC seeks to replace windows in home with Marvin Elevate in Bronze color with same light patterns at 161 Garden Street.

Upon motion by Commissioner Wolf seconded by Commissioner Lyons and a poll of the Commission, it was voted to APPROVE the application as submitted.

Discussion

Commissioner Wolf stated that she thinks that this window applied as described by the contractor is going to be appropriate in this situation. The dark color will help it blend in. The replacements of the muntins are like for like and they aren't losing old glass in this situation. She thinks it's going to be an appropriate replacement window in this particular case.

Commissioner Meade stated that she agrees with Commissioner Wolf. The information that they have been given by the contractor and the specific details of how he's going to install this window make it appropriate whereas it may not be appropriate in other installations.

Commissioner Hall stated that he thinks it's going to be appropriate for this house.

Aye: Wolf, Raymond, Lyons, Meade, Williams

MINUTES OF NOVEMBER 9, 2021

Upon motion by Commissioner Hall seconded by Commissioner Meade and a poll of the Commission, it was voted to APPROVE the meeting minutes of November 9, 2021, as submitted.

Aye: Wolf, Meade, Williams, Miglus, Hall, Cregeau

OTHER BUSINESS

Public Comments on General Matters of the Historic District

None.

Report of the Historic District Coordinator

None.

Correspondence

None.

ADJOURNMENT

Upon motion by Commissioner Raymond, seconded by Commissioner Lyons and a poll of the Commission, it was voted to ADJOURN the meeting at 9:21 PM.

Aye: Wolf, Raymond, Lyons, Meade, Williams

Respectfully Submitted

TOWN OF WETHERSFIELD
HISTORIC DISTRICT COMMISSION

Chris Lyons
- Clerk -